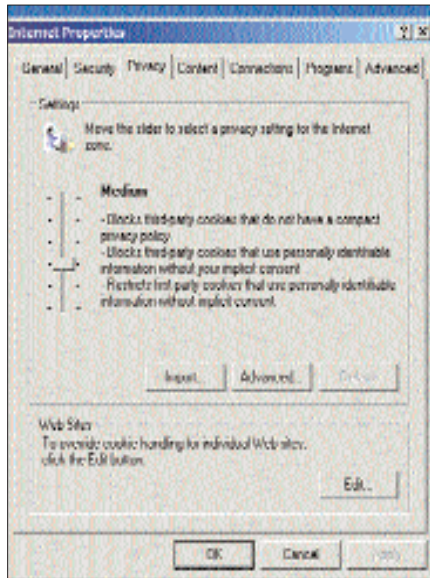


recording volume level. Check your recording and adjust this accordingly.

Pages that do not open

Q. I have an Athlon XP 2.4 GHz PC connected to a LAN, running Windows 98 SE and Internet Explorer 6 with SP1. The problem is that when I visit any of the Web sites such as Indiatimes, Yahoo! India, Rediff, MSN India, or others that contain ActiveX control (.ocx) files, I get a security alert message saying, "Your Current

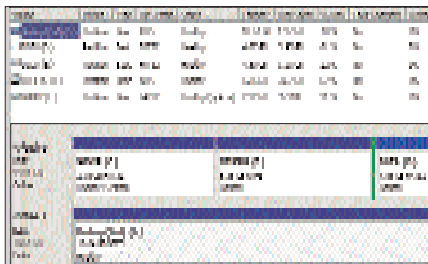


Moving the bar up and down controls the security

Security Settings Prohibit Running ActiveX Controls on this page, so the page may not display correctly." What do I do?

Abhijit Mukherjee

A To get over the problem, open up Internet Options in the Control Panel, and change the settings bar in the Privacy tab to Medium. If you wish to customise the settings, you can do so in the Security tab by clicking 'custom level' and defining your own settings.



The Disk Management window shows you the disk status

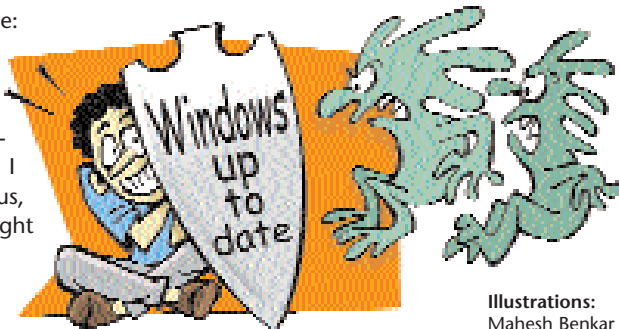
Vanishing act

Q. I have a 40 GB hard disk, split into three partitions. One of the partitions is 13 GB.

Last week, I reinstalled Windows XP on my system. After installation I seem to have lost the 13 GB drive—only two drives appear. What do I do?

Girish Cariappa

A You are infected with the blaster worm. Download the fix from <http://securityresponse.symantec.com/avcenter/venc/data/w32.blaster.worm.removal.to.01.html>. You need to frequently update your virus definitions. Also keep Windows updated with the security patches that are released by Microsoft from time to time. If you do so, you're less likely to get caught up in the Web of viruses and worms.



Illustrations: Mahesh Benkar

A Right-click on My Computer and click Manage. Now, click on Disk Management, and then verify that the 13 GB partition is formatted—that is, it should show the status as 'healthy'. If not, then right-click on the partition and select format. Now, you should be able to see the partition.

Spyware in file system

Q. How can I convert an NTFS partition into a FAT32 partition?

Every time I shut down my PC, I get an error message saying, "Ending Program - wupdater.exe." What is the use of this exe file? How can I get rid of this message permanently?

When I open Internet Explorer, every time a Web site with the address <http://searchcentral.cc> is opened. I tried the 'Use Blank' option in Internet Options, but it isn't working.

Sumit Goel

A Use Partition magic (www.powerquest.com) to convert NTFS to FAT32.

As far as wupdater.exe is concerned, it is spyware. Go to **Start > Run**, type 'msconfig' and press [Enter] and de-select the file. It shouldn't auto-start the next time Windows boots up. Delete the file if you want to, but that might crash the software that installed it.

Finally, the IE problem is also due to the spyware in your system. There are spyware removal tools such as Spybot (included in this month's 101 Freeware CD), which reduce the trouble involved in manually searching and removing each one of them.

Is /boot necessary?

Q. Can I install Linux without creating partitions for /boot and swap? If so, where will the boot loader install?

S. Mohammed Riyazudeen

A No, you can't install Linux without a swap partition, but you can skip the creation of a separate /boot partition. In this case, the boot files will be stored in the /root partition.

Windows is not ready to install

Q. I have a Celeron 1.2 GHz, an Intel i810 motherboard and a 40 GB Seagate hard disk. Earlier, my PC was running Windows 98; while installing ELX Linux, I corrupted my FAT partition. So I removed all the partitions and re-created them, but now even

A virus despite anti-virus

Q. I have a PC with Windows XP. I recently bought an Internet connection pack, but before installing the pack, I installed McAfee Virus Scan Professional Edition. Now, whenever I connect to the Internet, I get the message that says, "This system is shutting down. Please save all work in progress and log off. Any unsaved changes will be lost. This shutdown was initiated by NT AUTHORITY\SYSTEM. Time before shutdown: 1 minute. Message: Windows must now restart because the Remote Procedure Call(RPC) service terminated unexpectedly". I have tried to detect a virus, but to no avail. What might be the problem?

V Madhav Rao